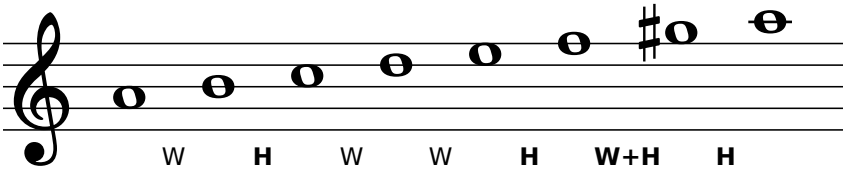
# Harmonic and Melodic Minor

In natural minor, degree 7 is a whole step below the tonic and does not lead strongly back to it. The other two forms raise degree 7 by a half step to make a leading tone. The raised note is written as an accidental each time it appears; it is never part of the key signature.

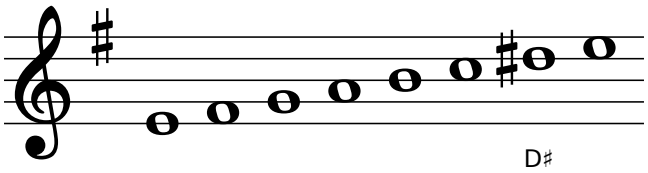
## Harmonic minor

The **harmonic minor scale** is the natural minor scale with degree 7 raised. This leaves a gap of three half steps between degrees 6 and 7, a whole step plus a half step (W+H), which gives harmonic minor its distinctive sound. Pattern: **W H W W H W+H H**.

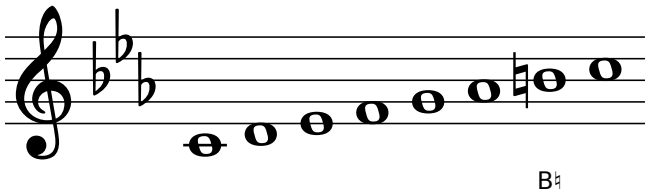



A harmonic minor: G♯ is the raised 7th.

Raising a natural note adds a sharp. When degree 7 is flat in the key signature, a natural sign raises it.



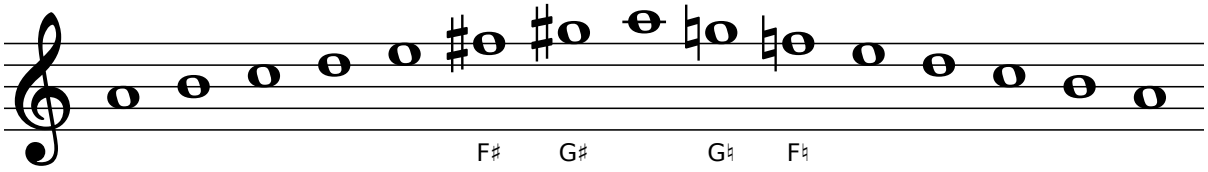

E harmonic minor: D♯




C harmonic minor: B♮

## Melodic minor

The **melodic minor scale** smooths out the gap by raising degrees 6 and 7 on the way up. On the way down, both return to their natural form, so melodic minor descends as natural minor. Ascending pattern: **W H W W W W H**. Natural signs cancel the raised notes on the way down.




A melodic minor, up and down: F♯ and G♯ up, G♮ and F♮ down.

## The three forms in A minor

| Form | Notes | Degrees 6 and 7 |
|---|---|---|
| Natural | A B C D E F G A | as in the key signature |
| Harmonic | A B C D E F G♯ A | 7 raised |
| Melodic, up | A B C D E F♯ G♯ A | 6 and 7 raised |
| Melodic, down | A G F E D C B A | as in the key signature |

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Name _____ Date _____

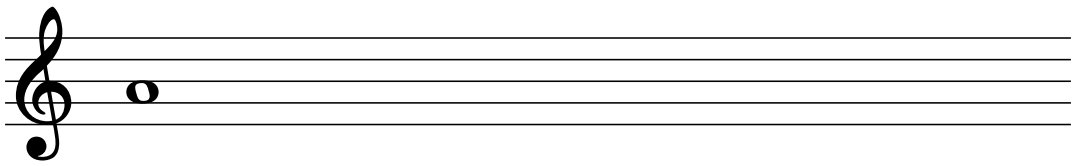
# Harmonic Minor Scales

**A. The harmonic minor pattern** Fill in the pattern. Write W+H for the step of three half steps.

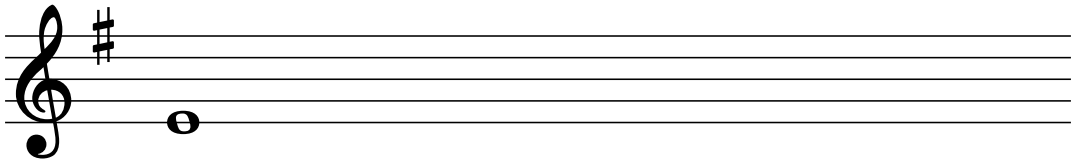
| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Harmonic minor: | W | | | | | | |

**B. Write harmonic minor scales** The key signature is given. Write each scale ascending and add the raised 7th as an accidental. Mark each half step.

**A harmonic minor**



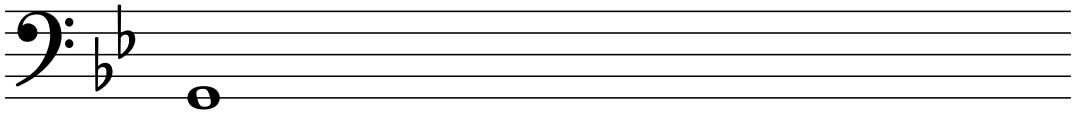
**E harmonic minor**



**D harmonic minor**



**G harmonic minor**



**C. The raised 7th** Write the raised 7th of each harmonic minor scale.

**EXAMPLE** A harmonic minor: G♯

1. E harmonic minor: _____
2. D harmonic minor: _____
3. B harmonic minor: _____
4. G harmonic minor: _____
5. F♯ harmonic minor: _____
6. C harmonic minor: _____
7. Name of the raised 7th: _____
8. Half steps from 6 to 7: _____

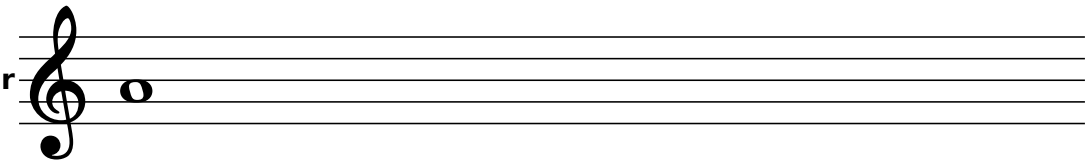
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Name _____ Date _____

# Melodic Minor and Scale Forms

**A. Write melodic minor scales** The key signature is given. Write each scale up and then down on one line. Raise 6 and 7 on the way up; cancel them with accidentals on the way down. Mark each half step.

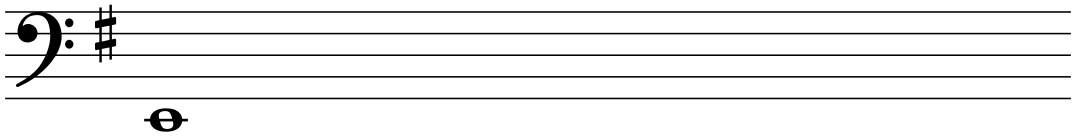
**A melodic minor**



**D melodic minor**

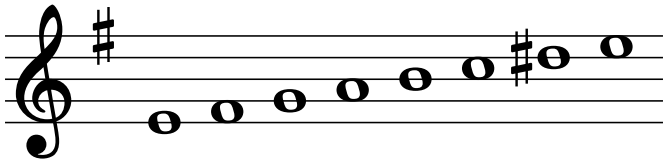


**E melodic minor**



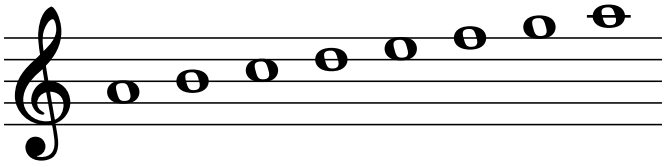
**B. Name the form** Write natural, harmonic, or melodic for each ascending scale.

**EXAMPLE**



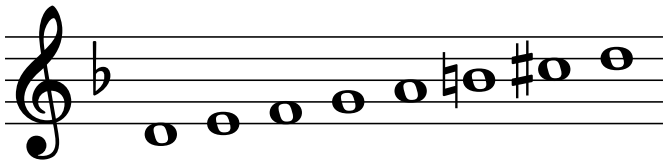
harmonic

1.



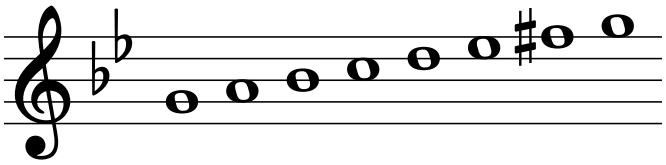
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2.



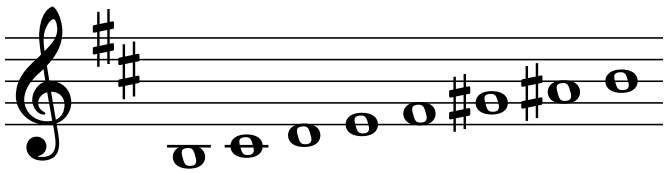
_____

3.



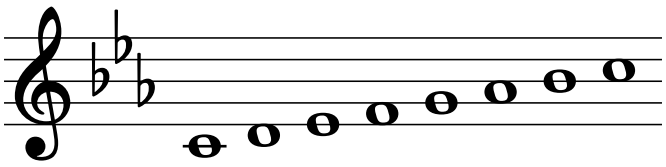
_____

4.



_____

5.



_____

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